

First-Week Tasks: New SWE Onboarding

Guiding principle: don't say "go through the project and improve it" right away — that invites random, ungrounded changes from AI coding tools. Give bounded ownership first.

First-Week Tasks

1. Get oriented

- Read `README.md`, `SETUP.md`, `CAUSEY-DESIGN-SYSTEM.txt`, and `anti-vibecode-rules.txt`.
- Run `npm install`, `npm test`, `npm run build`, and `npm run dev`.
- Test `/`, `/chess`, `/event/[slug]`, `/pathways`, `/signup`, `/me`, `/family`, and `/orgs`.
- Use mock data; do not modify `.env` or Supabase.

Deliverable: a short list of confusing setup instructions, broken flows, and outdated documentation.

2. Fix the outdated README

- `README.md` incorrectly says accounts, auth, and admin UI do not exist.
- Update it to accurately describe the current product and routes.
- Preserve the honest early-build language — don't claim everything is complete or verified.

Acceptance: another new developer can understand what currently works and run the app without help.

3. Audit empty, error, and success states

- Choose one workflow: `/me`, `/family`, or `/orgs`.
- Test its empty, loading, error, and successful states.
- Make sure each state clearly names the next action.
- Reuse existing components, tokens, and button patterns.

Acceptance: one focused UX improvement, tests/build passing, and screenshots before and after.

4. Add one meaningful regression test

- Pick a behavior she found while auditing the app.
- Add or improve a Vitest test under `tests/`.
- Avoid tests that only check exact wording or implementation details.

Acceptance: demonstrate that the test fails without the fix and passes with it.

5. Terminology and accessibility pass

- Audit one complete flow for keyboard access, form labels, focus states, external-link labels, and consistent terms.
- Keep “Causey RSVP” distinct from “organizer registration.”
- Fix only issues in that selected flow — no site-wide rewrite.

For Every Task

- Work only on `dev`; never touch `main`.
- Pull `origin/dev` before starting.
- Run `npm test` and `npm run build`.
- Update `.cursor/district-ux-progress.md`.
- Make one focused commit and push only `origin/dev`.
- Ask Cursor to explain unfamiliar code before editing it.

Recommended First Coding Task

The best first coding task is adding `tests/format.test.ts` for `lib/format.ts`. It is bounded, low-risk, and teaches the test setup without touching auth or data.

Current baseline: 152 passing tests across 26 files.

Have her run the following first, since other local changes are already present in the repo:

```
git status
```

Longer-Term Ownership

After the first week, give her one of these areas:

- **New-developer experience:** keep setup docs, architecture notes, and onboarding checks accurate.
- **Workflow QA:** rotate weekly through student, parent, coach, and org-admin flows; turn findings into one bounded fix at a time.
- **Regression testing:** add coverage whenever a real bug or confusing state is found.
- **Accessibility:** maintain keyboard, labeling, focus, mobile, and reduced-motion quality across one route group.
- **Data-trust research:** verify tournament/pathway facts against official sources and record citations — never invent or silently “correct” data.

Off-Limits for Now

Initially keep her away from the following. These areas need guided pairing first:

- Supabase migrations / RLS
- Authentication permissions
- Scraper architecture
- Production environment variables
- Anything involving student privacy